

BASIC SIGHT-SINGING AND EAR TRAINING FOR CHURCH SINGERS

UNIT 5.2

PITCH

THE KEYS OF F AND G MAJOR.

SHARPS AND FLATS.

APPLYING SOLFÈGE IN REAL-LIFE SITUATIONS.



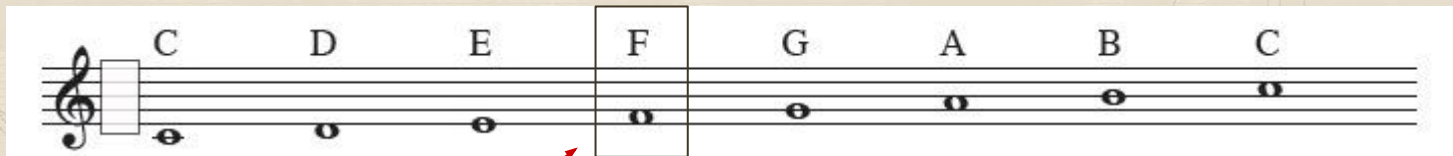
TRANSPOSING THE MAJOR SCALE TO OTHER KEYS

In Unit 4.2 (Slide 2) we defined the **major scale** as an arrangement pitches having a specific sequence of **whole steps** and **half steps** (W=whole step, H=half step):

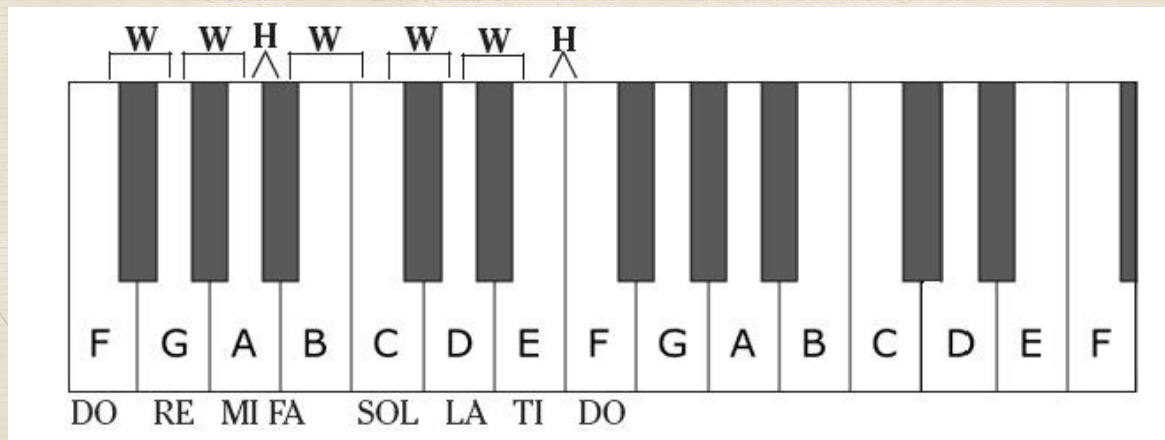
	W		W		H		W		W		W		H	
DO	-	RE	-	MI	-	FA	-	SOL	-	LA	-	TI	-	DO

Some of the examples in Unit 5.1 - Rhythm (Examples 1, 2, 3 and 4 on Slides 3 thru 7), which are notated in the Key of C, contained notes that were quite low in the vocal range. In order to make the range more comfortable, we can **transpose** the music to a different key—that is, **move** the entire array of notes up or down in pitch by a certain constant interval. In fact, this can be done with the **entire** major scale.

We will see how this works as we transpose the scale up, first by a **fourth** and then by a **fifth**.



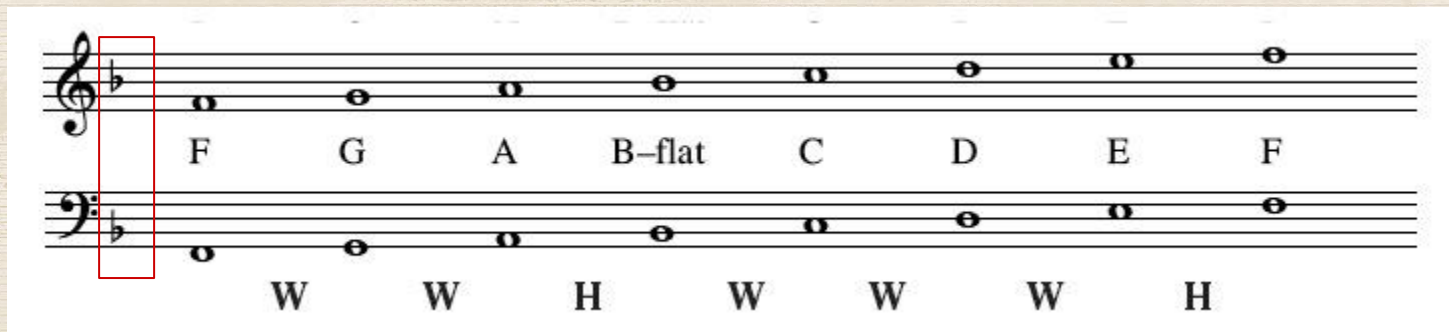
Starting with the C Major scale, we find the fourth note up, which is an F, and we make it our new **tonic**, calling it DO. As we begin building our major scale starting on the note F, it becomes necessary to lower the fourth note, “B” by half a step in order to keep the same arrangement of whole steps and half steps: W W H W W W H. This can be seen visually by looking at the arrangement of keys on the piano:



THE F MAJOR SCALE - THE FLAT SYMBOL (b)

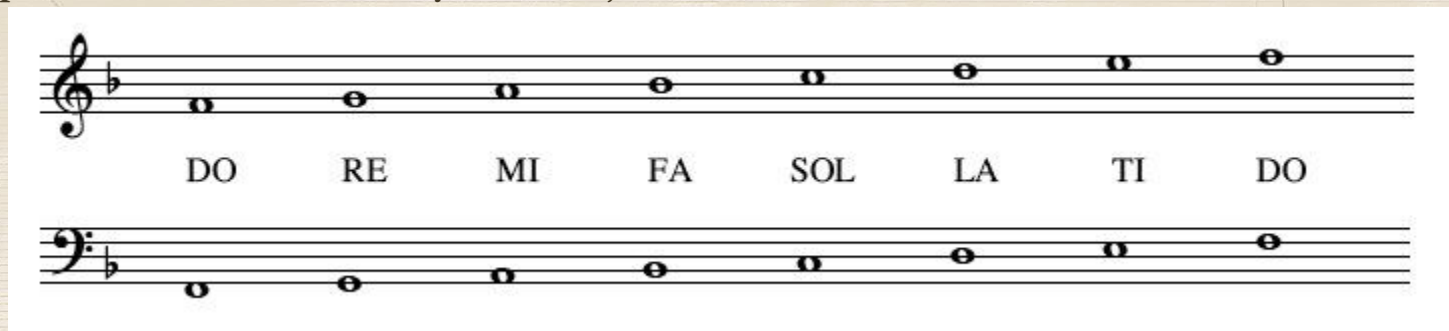
Whereas the C Major scale was made up of all white keys, having no sharps or flats, now we must add the symbol (b) in front of the note B, which **lowers** the note by a half step. The same can be accomplished by putting the flat as a **key signature** on the middle line in treble clef or the second line in bass clef (e.g., the lines that correspond to the note “B”).

Here is what the **F Major scale** looks like in treble and bass clef:



Notice the arrangement of whole steps and half steps.

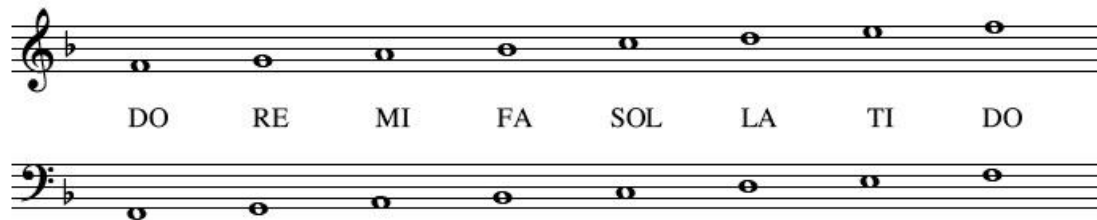
Starting on the note “F” we can sing the F Major scale using SOL-FA syllables, which immediately provides us with a lot of information about the **pitches** and **intervals** for any piece of music in the Key of F Major: **we have heard them all before!**



Thus, we recognize that the interval from F to G (DO-RE) is a whole step; from F to A (DO-MI) is a Major Third; from G to B-flat (RE-FA) is a Minor Third; from G up to C (RE-SOL) is a Perfect Fourth, and so on.

As we encounter these notes and syllables again and again, the sound of the interval “F-A,” or “G-C $\uparrow$,” for example, becomes part of our personal **musical “knowledge base,”** from where it can easily be retrieved as needed.

Looking at the notes of the F Major scale below, practice your musical “multiplication tables.”



1. Seconds

DO	RE	DO	Major Second (whole step)
RE	MI	RE	Major Second (whole step)
MI	FA	MI	Minor Second (half step)
FA	SOL	FA	Major Second (whole step)
SOL	LA	SOL	Major Second (whole step)
LA	TI	LA	Major Second (whole step)
TI	DO	TI	Minor Second (half step)
DO			

3. Fourths

DO	FA	DO	Perfect fourth (whole, whole, half)
RE	SOL	RE	Perfect fourth (whole, half, whole)
MI	LA	MI	Perfect fourth (half, whole, whole)
FA	TI	FA	Augmented fourth (tritone) (whole, whole, whole)
SOL	DO	SOL	Perfect fourth (whole, whole, half)
LA	RE	LA	Perfect fourth (whole, half, whole)
TI	MI	TI	Perfect fourth (half, whole, whole)
DO			

2. Thirds

DO	MI	DO	Major third (whole step, whole step)
RE	FA	RE	Minor third (whole step, half step)
MI	SOL	MI	Minor third (half step, whole step)
FA	LA	FA	Major third (whole step, whole step)
SOL	TI	SOL	Major third (whole step, whole step)
LA	DO	LA	Minor third (whole step, half step)
TI	RE	TI	Minor third (half step, whole step)
DO			

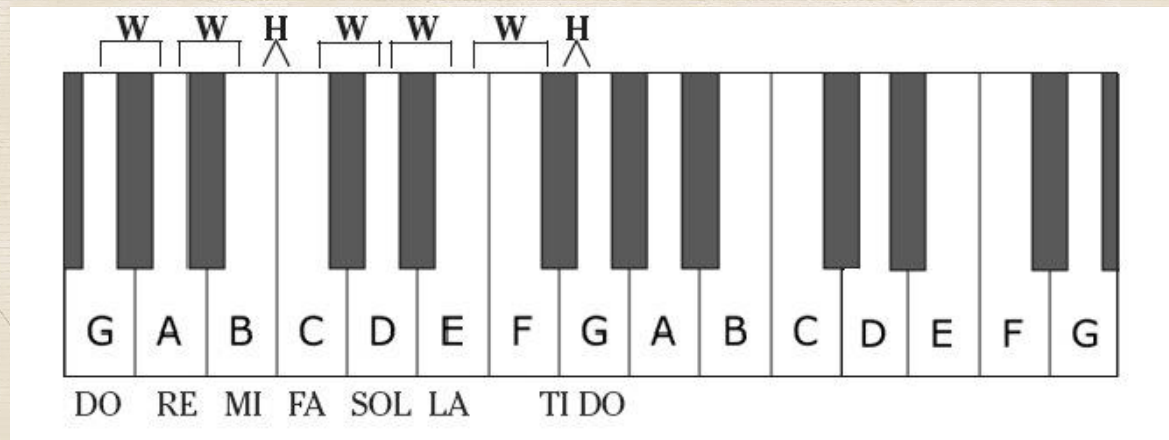
4. Fifths

DO	SOL	DO	Perfect fifth (whole, whole, half, whole)
RE	LA	RE	Perfect fifth (whole, half, whole, whole)
MI	TI	MI	Perfect fifth (half, whole, whole, whole)
FA	DO	FA	Perfect fifth (whole, whole, whole, half)
SOL	RE	SOL	Perfect fifth (whole, whole, half, whole)
LA	MI	LA	Perfect fifth (whole, half, whole, whole)
TI	FA	TI	Diminished fifth (tritone) (half, whole, whole, half)
DO			

THE G MAJOR SCALE

Like the key of F Major, the G-major scale is also frequently encountered in Orthodox church music because its notes lie in a convenient range for many voices.

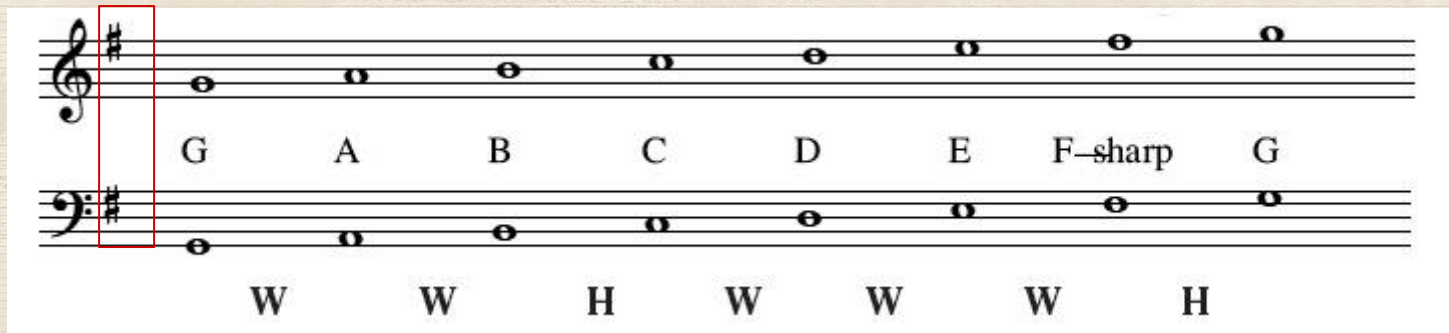
Starting with the fifth note up from C, which is G, we make it our new **tonic**, calling it DO. As we begin building our major scale starting on the note G, it becomes necessary to raise the seventh note, “F” by half a step in order to keep the same arrangement of whole steps and half steps: W W H W W W H.



THE SHARP SYMBOL (#)

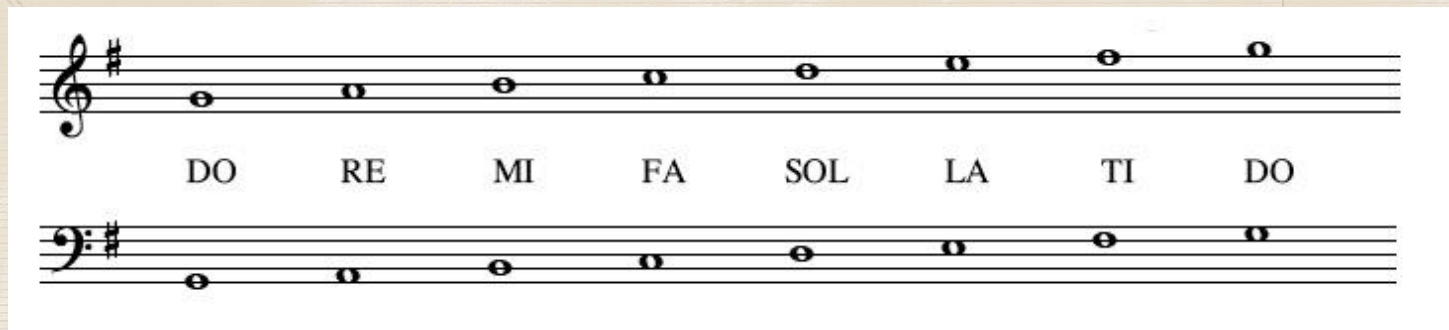
The sharp symbol (#), which is added in front of the note F, **raises** the note by a half step. Rather than having to add the sharp before every F in the G Major scale, it is added as a **key signature** on the fifth line in treble clef or the fourth line in bass clef (e.g., the lines that correspond to the note “F”).)

Here is what the **G Major scale** looks like in treble and bass clef:



Notice the arrangement of whole steps and half steps.

Starting on the note “G” we can sing the G Major scale using SOL-FA syllables and, as in the F Major scale, we encounter a lot of familiar intervals.



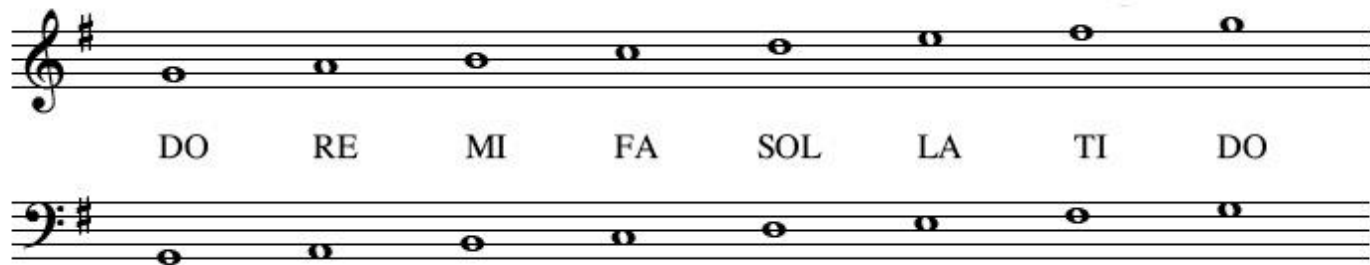
Practice your “multiplication tables” as you look at the notes of the G Major scale.

1. Seconds

DO	RE	DO	Major Second (whole step)
RE	MI	RE	Major Second (whole step)
MI	FA	MI	Minor Second (half step)
FA	SOL	FA	Major Second (whole step)
SOL	LA	SOL	Major Second (whole step)
LA	TI	LA	Major Second (whole step)
TI	DO	TI	Minor Second (half step)
DO			

2. Thirds

DO	MI	DO	Major third (whole step, whole step)
RE	FA	RE	Minor third (whole step, half step)
MI	SOL	MI	Minor third (half step, whole step)
FA	LA	FA	Major third (whole step, whole step)
SOL	TI	SOL	Major third (whole step, whole step)
LA	DO	LA	Minor third (whole step, half step)
TI	RE	TI	Minor third (half step, whole step)
DO			



3. Fourths

DO	FA	DO	Perfect fourth (whole, whole, half)
RE	SOL	RE	Perfect fourth (whole, half, whole)
MI	LA	MI	Perfect fourth (half, whole, whole)
FA	TI	FA	Augmented fourth (tritone) (whole, whole, whole)
SOL	DO	SOL	Perfect fourth (whole, whole, half)
LA	RE	LA	Perfect fourth (whole, half, whole)
TI	MI	TI	Perfect fourth (half, whole, whole)
DO			

4. Fifths

DO	SOL	DO	Perfect fifth (whole, whole, half, whole)
RE	LA	RE	Perfect fifth (whole, half, whole, whole)
MI	TI	MI	Perfect fifth (half, whole, whole, whole)
FA	DO	FA	Perfect fifth (whole, whole, whole, half)
SOL	RE	SOL	Perfect fifth (whole, whole, half, whole)
LA	MI	LA	Perfect fifth (whole, half, whole, whole)
TI	FA	TI	Diminished fifth (tritone) (half, whole, whole, half)
DO			

APPLYING SOLFÈGE TO REAL-LIFE SITUATIONS

The ability to “sight-sing” a melody involves being able to do the following:

1. **Recognize and name** each note
2. **Associate** that name and the subsequent patterns (intervals) with **previously familiar patterns** in the singer’s experience

*“In a very real sense, sight-singing amounts to nothing more than the fluent retrieval of information, more or less the same thing that occurs when reading a printed language.” *)*

*)Levine, Art. “‘Movable do’ and ‘Fixed do’: What they are, what they aren’t, and why ‘movable do’ should be used as the basis for musicianship training.”

https://www.artlevine.com/wp-content/uploads/ear_training/movabledo.pdf (accessed 10/26/2020)

Attempts to create a music notation system based entirely on solfège syllables have proven to be impractical (except for teaching small children).

Church singers today are typically confronted with music in Western staff notation and are called upon to “recognize” the music that the notation expresses. Rather than an end in itself, solfège becomes an important tool in the “fluent retrieval of information”— one of a number of strategies a singer can employ to sight-sing an unfamiliar melody. In addition to the knowledge of intervals expressed in solfège syllables, other strategies include:

- knowledge and recognition of different keys, scales, and modes
- knowledge and recognition of triads
- knowledge of the patterns of Eight Tones or Modes (the Octoechos)

You are now ready to learn more about
the notes and intervals of the
F AND G MAJOR SCALES
IN STAFF NOTATION

Please proceed to
PITCH EXERCISES 5.1 & 5.2

